

# DaTra: Data Transformation Semantics as a Symmetric Monoidal Category on Atlas Presheaves

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## Abstract

This work formalizes the semantics of the Datra programming-language project in Lean. Data domains are organized into atlases: structured, eventually stable families of pages encoding how data is partitioned and related. Data transformations are modeled as presheaves on the resulting atlas categories, yielding a topos-theoretic semantics. Stable transformations are then assembled over atlas confederations. A confederation retains both the tagged inputs of an atlas merge and the atlas produced by that merge; forgetting the tags recovers an ordinary atlas. Horizontal sum extends by Day convolution to a symmetric monoidal category.

## 1 Dominions

**Definition 1.1** (The Category of Dominions). The **Category of Dominions**, denoted  $\mathbf{Dom}$ , has as its objects sets whose cardinality is at most  $\omega_0$ , equivalently sets admitting an injection into  $\omega_0$ , and as its morphisms set-theoretic functions.

**Definition 1.2** (The Domanial Embedding Functor). The **Domanial Embedding Functor**, denoted  $\mathbf{Emb} : \mathbf{Dom} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$ , sends each dominion to its underlying set.

## 2 Domanial Insertions

**Definition 2.1** (The Category of Domanial Insertions). The **Category of Domanial Insertions**, denoted  $\mathbf{DomIns}$ , has dominions as objects and monomorphisms in  $\mathbf{Dom}$  as morphisms.

**Definition 2.2** (The Category of Codomanial Insertions). The **Category of Codomanial Insertions**, denoted  $\mathbf{CoDomIns}$ , is the opposite category  $\mathbf{DomIns}^{\mathrm{op}}$ .

## 3 Chains

**Definition 3.1** (Chain). A **Chain** is a totally ordered thin category, indexed skeletally by an ordinal strictly smaller than  $\omega_0^{\omega_0}$ .

**Definition 3.2** (The Spine). The **spine** is the chain with  $\omega_0$  objects.

## 4 Consolidations

**Definition 4.1** (The Category of Consolidations). The **Category of Consolidations**, denoted  $\mathbf{Con}$ , has chains as objects and point-surjective functors between their thin categories as morphisms.

**Definition 4.2** (The Category of Coconsolidations). The **Category of Coconsolidations**, denoted  $\mathbf{CoCon}$ , is the opposite category  $\mathbf{Con}^{\mathrm{op}}$ .

**Definition 4.3** (Consolidation Transport). The **Consolidation Transport Functor** is denoted  $\text{ConTra}$ . It is a functor from  $\text{Con}$  to  $\text{Set}$  that sends a chain to its object set and a consolidation to its underlying set-theoretic surjection.

## 5 Folios and Paginations

**Definition 5.1** (Folio). A **folio** is a functor  $F : S \rightarrow \text{CoCon}$ , where  $S$  is the spine, such that  $F(0)$  is the singleton chain.

**Definition 5.2** (Page Elements). For a folio  $F$ , its **category of page elements**, denoted  $\text{El}(F)$ , has as objects pairs  $(m, k)$ , where  $m$  is a page and  $k$  is an object of the chain  $F(m)$ . An arrow  $(m, k) \rightarrow (n, l)$  is an arrow  $f : m \rightarrow n$  in the opposite spine for which the consolidation induced by  $F$  transports  $k$  exactly to  $l$ . Equivalently,

$$\text{El}(F) = \int (\text{ConTra} \circ F^{\text{op}}).$$

**Definition 5.3** (The Category of Paginations). The **Category of Paginations**, denoted  $\text{Pag}$ , has as objects a folio  $Fo$  together with its associated category of page elements  $El = \text{El}(Fo)$ . For  $W : \text{Pag}$ , write  $W_{Fo}$  for its folio and  $W_{El}$  for its page-element category. A morphism  $T : X \rightarrow Y$  in  $\text{Pag}$  is a functor  $T : X_{El} \rightarrow Y_{El}$ .

For illustration, let  $X_H := \text{ConTra} \circ X_{Fo}^{\text{op}}$  and define  $Y_H$  likewise. If an arrow  $f$  of  $X_{El}$  has source  $x = (m, i)$ , then  $T$  acts schematically as follows:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} x = (m, i) & \xrightarrow{f} & (n, X_H(f)(i)) \\ T \downarrow & & \downarrow T \\ (m', i') & \xrightarrow{T(f)} & (n', Y_H(T(f))(i')). \end{array}$$

## 6 Atlases

**Definition 6.1** (The Category of Atlases). The **Category of Atlases**, denoted  $\text{Atl}$ , has as objects pairs  $(Pa, Da)$ , where  $Pa : \text{Pag}$  and  $Da : Pa_{El} \rightarrow \text{Domlns}$  is a functor, equivalently a presheaf  $Da : Pa_{El}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{CoDomlns}$ . For the folio  $Pa_{Fo}$ , a page  $m$ , and distinct objects  $k, k'$  of the chain  $Pa_{Fo}(m)$ , the pullback in  $Da$  of the arrows induced by  $(m \rightarrow 0)(k)$  and  $(m \rightarrow 0)(k')$  is empty.

For  $X : \text{Atl}$ , write  $X_{Pa}$  and  $X_{Da}$  for its two components, and abbreviate  $X_{Fo} := (X_{Pa})_{Fo}$  and  $X_{El} := (X_{Pa})_{El}$ .

For every  $n \in \mathbb{N}$ , the  $n$ **th atlas page** of  $X$  is the chain  $X_{Fo}(n)$  on its full spine. An object  $k$  of this chain is a **page cell**, written  $(n, k)$ , and the dominion carried by that cell is  $X_{Da}(n, k)$ .

There is an integer  $w$  such that, for every  $w' > w$ , the consolidation from page  $w'$  to page  $w$  induced by  $Pa_{Fo}$  is the identity and, for every object  $k$  of  $Pa_{Fo}(w)$ , the corresponding arrow  $Da((w' \rightarrow w)(k))$  is the identity. The least such integer is the **cardinality of the atlas**, denoted  $|A|$ .

A morphism  $T : X \rightarrow Y$  is a pair  $(T_{Pa}, T_{Da})$ , where  $T_{Pa} : X_{El} \rightarrow Y_{El}$  is a functor and  $T_{Da} : X_{Da} \Rightarrow Y_{Da} \circ T_{Pa}$  is a natural transformation. Thus, for every  $f : x \rightarrow y$  in  $X_{El}$ , the following square commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X_{Da}(x) & \xrightarrow{X_{Da}(f)} & X_{Da}(y) \\ (T_{Da})_x \downarrow & & \downarrow (T_{Da})_y \\ Y_{Da}(T_{Pa}(x)) & \xrightarrow{Y_{Da}(T_{Pa}(f))} & Y_{Da}(T_{Pa}(y)). \end{array}$$

Finally, if  $x = |X|$ ,  $x' > x$ , and  $r$  is an object of the final chain  $X_{Fo}(|X| - 1)$ , then  $T_{Pa}(x', r) = T_{Pa}(x, r)$  and  $(T_{Da})_{(x', r)} = (T_{Da})_{(x, r)}$ .

**Definition 6.2** (Extent of an Atlas). The **extent** of  $A$  is  $\text{Ex}(A) = A_{Da}(0, 0)$ . Since objects of  $\text{Domlns}$  are dominions,  $\text{Ex}(A) : \text{Dom}$  for every  $A : \text{Atl}$ .

**Definition 6.3** (Territory of an Atlas). Let  $M$  be the objects of the final chain  $A_{Fo}(|A| - 1)$ . The **territory** is the indexed family  $\text{Ter}(A) : M \rightarrow \text{Dom}$  given by  $\text{Ter}(A)(k) = A_{Da}(|A| - 1, k)$ .

**Definition 6.4** ( $n$ th Region of an Atlas). The  **$n$ th region** of  $A$  is  $\text{Ter}(A)(n)$ , with indexing beginning at 0.

**Definition 6.5** (Covered Page Element). A **covered page element** of an atlas  $X$  is a page element  $x$  together with a datum  $t \in X_{Da}(x)$  whose image in the extent is the image of a datum in a final region.

## 7 Transposals and Transversals

**Definition 7.1** (The Category of Atlas Transposals). The **Category of Atlas Transposals**, denoted  $\text{AtlTrap}$ , is the wide subcategory of  $\text{Atl}$  whose morphisms  $F : X \rightarrow Y$  have point-injective object maps  $F_{Pa}$ .

**Definition 7.2** (The Category of Ordered Atlas Transposals). The **Category of Ordered Atlas Transposals**, denoted  $\text{OrdAtlTrap}$ , is the wide subcategory of  $\text{AtlTrap}$  whose morphisms preserve the strict order on page elements. Explicitly, for  $F : X \rightarrow Y$ , let  $x = (m, i)$  and  $y = (m', j)$ , put  $p = \min(m, m')$ , write  $F_{Pa}(x) = (n, i')$  and  $F_{Pa}(y) = (n', j')$ , and put  $p' = \min(n, n')$ . If  $c_{m,p}^X$  and  $c_{m',p}^X$  are the induced consolidations, and likewise for  $Y$ , then

$$c_{m,p}^X(i) < c_{m',p}^X(j) \implies c_{n,p'}^Y(i') < c_{n',p'}^Y(j').$$

**Definition 7.3** (The Category of Atlas Transversals). The **Category of Atlas Transversals**, denoted  $\text{AtlTrav}$ , is the wide subcategory of  $\text{OrdAtlTrap}$  whose morphisms preserve covered page elements: the exact image of every covered page element is covered.

**Definition 7.4** (The Category of Stable Atlas Transversals). The **Category of Stable Atlas Transversals**, denoted  $\text{StaAtlTrav}$ , is the wide subcategory of  $\text{AtlTrav}$  whose morphisms  $F : X \rightarrow Y$  satisfy  $F_{Pa}(0, 0) = (0, 0)$ .

## 8 Maps and Cartography

**Definition 8.1** (The Category of Atlas Maps). The **Category of Atlas Maps**, denoted  $\text{AtlMap}$ , is the full subcategory of atlases for which every element of the extent is in the image of a final region.

**Definition 8.2** (The Atlas Map Inclusion Functor). The **Atlas Map Inclusion Functor**  $\text{AtlMapInc} : \text{AtlMap} \rightarrow \text{Atl}$  is the canonical inclusion.

**Definition 8.3** (The Category of Atlas Transversal Maps). The **Category of Atlas Transversal Maps**, denoted  $\text{AtlTravMap}$ , is the full subcategory of  $\text{AtlTrav}$  whose objects are Atlas Maps.

**Definition 8.4** (The Atlas Transversal Map Inclusion Functor). The canonical inclusion is denoted  $\text{AtlTravMapInc} : \text{AtlTravMap} \rightarrow \text{AtlTrav}$ .

**Lemma 8.5** (Cartography Lemma). *The inclusion  $\text{AtlTravMapInc}$  has a right adjoint, denoted the **Charter Functor**  $\text{Chr} : \text{AtlTrav} \rightarrow \text{AtlTravMap}$ .*

*Proof sketch. On an object  $X : \text{AtlTrav}$ , the functor  $\text{Chr}$  sends  $X$  to the universal arrow from  $\text{AtlTravMapInc}$  to  $X$ . Write  $X' = \text{AtlTravMapInc}(\text{Chr}(X))$ , together with  $H : X' \rightarrow X$ , with  $X'$  terminal among objects having this property. The solution is the  $\text{DaTra}$  map satisfying  $\text{Ter}(X') \cong \text{Ter}(X)$ . It is unique because  $\text{AtlTrav}$  preserves orders and terminal because  $H_{Pa}$  is faithful.*

## 9 Coalitions

**Definition 9.1** (The Coalizing Functor). The **Coalizing Functor**, denoted

$$\text{Coa} : \text{StaAtlTrav} \longrightarrow \text{DomIns},$$

is the extent of the charted atlas:  $\text{Coa} = \text{Ex} \circ \text{Chr}$ .

**Definition 9.2** (The Coalition of an Atlas). The **coalition** of an atlas  $X$  is the extent of its chart, regarding  $X$  as an object of the wide category of stable transversals.

**Definition 9.3** (The Domanial Inclusion Functor). The **Domanial Inclusion Functor** sends a dominion to the atlas of cardinality 1 whose coalition is that dominion. Write  $\text{DomInc} : \text{DomIns} \rightarrow \text{StaAtlTrav}$  for this functor. It is left adjoint to  $\text{Coa}$ : for  $X : \text{DomIns}$  and  $Y : \text{StaAtlTrav}$ , naturally in  $X$  and  $Y$ ,

$$\text{Hom}_{\text{StaAtlTrav}}(\text{DomInc}(X), Y) \cong \text{Hom}_{\text{DomIns}}(X, \text{Coa}(Y)),$$

and  $\text{Coa}(\text{DomInc}(X)) \cong X$ .

## 10 Atlas Confederations

**Definition 10.1** (Atlas Merge). The **Atlas Merge** is the object operation

$$\text{AtlMerge} : \text{Ob}(\text{Atl}) \times \text{Ob}(\text{Atl}) \longrightarrow \text{Ob}(\text{Atl}).$$

For atlases  $X$  and  $Y$ , the extent of  $\text{AtlMerge}(X, Y)$  is the disjoint union of their extents. Both atlases are evaluated on their full spines: page  $n + 1$  of the merge is the tagged, componentwise combination of page  $n$  of  $X$  and page  $n$  of  $Y$ .

**Definition 10.2** (Atlas Confederation). An **Atlas Confederation** is the data carried by an atlas merge: a countable tagged family of atlas objects together with a merge presentation whose evaluation is the resulting atlas. The category of Atlas Confederations is denoted  $\text{AtlFed}$ . A morphism consists of a map of tags and, at each source tag, a stable atlas transversal to its selected target tag. There is a canonical object-level forgetful operation  $U : \text{Ob}(\text{AtlFed}) \rightarrow \text{Ob}(\text{Atl})$  that discards the component tags and retains the resulting atlas.

**Definition 10.3** (Atlas Federation). An **Atlas Federation** is an Atlas Confederation  $(A_i)_{i \in I}$  such that, for distinct  $i, j \in I$ , either the region-indexing chains of  $A_i$  and  $A_j$  have different order types, or some pair of corresponding regions (under their order isomorphism) has no common element; equivalently, there is no pair of morphisms from the one-element dominion to those two regions.

**Definition 10.4** (The Empty Atlas). The **Empty Atlas** is  $\text{Atl} = \text{DomInc}(\emptyset)$ , also viewed as the empty Atlas Confederation, whose tag family is empty and whose stored result is  $\text{Atl}$ .

**Definition 10.5** (The Atlas Horizontal Sum Bifunctor). The **Atlas Horizontal Sum Bifunctor**, denoted  $\text{AtlHorSum} : \text{AtlFed} \times \text{AtlFed} \rightarrow \text{AtlFed}$ , has object action

$$U(\text{AtlHorSum}(F, F')) = \text{AtlMerge}(U(F), U(F')).$$

On tags,  $\text{AtlHorSum}(F, F')$  is their disjoint tagged union; its stored merge presentation records the displayed atlas merge. Thus the horizontal sum preserves both the provenance of the two inputs and the atlas produced by merging them. The empty confederation represents  $\text{Atl}$ . Given stable transversals between the components of two pairs of confederations, horizontal sum preserves the left and right tags and applies the transversals componentwise. Stability fixes the common origin, so the component arrows remain stable atlas transversals.

**Lemma 10.6** (Horizontal Lemma). *The Atlas Horizontal Sum Bifunctor  $\text{AtlHorSum}$  exists.*

*Proof. Identity arrows act identically on every tag, composition holds componentwise, and every component arrow is required to lie in  $\text{StaAtlTrav}$ . The confederation structure supplies the associator, unitors, and braider by reassociation, deletion of the empty tag family, and tag swapping, respectively.*

**Definition 10.7** (The Atlas Braider). The **Atlas Braider**  $\text{AtlBrd}_{F, F'} : \text{AtlHorSum}(F, F') \rightarrow \text{AtlHorSum}(F', F)$  swaps the left and right component tags. Hence  $\text{AtlBrd}_{F, F'} \circ \text{AtlBrd}_{F', F} = \text{Id}$ .

**Definition 10.8** (The Atlas Associator). The **Atlas Associator**, denoted

$$\text{AtlAsoc}_{F, F', F''} : \text{AtlHorSum}(\text{AtlHorSum}(F, F'), F'') \longrightarrow \text{AtlHorSum}(F, \text{AtlHorSum}(F', F'')),$$

flattens the nested confederation and retags its three sides using the canonical reassociation  $((x + y) + z) \leftrightarrow (x + (y + z))$ . Its data component is the matching reassociation of the three extent summands.

**Definition 10.9** (The Atlas Unitors). The **Atlas Left Unitor**  $\text{Lu} : \text{AtlHorSum}(\text{Atl}, F) \rightarrow F$  and the **Atlas Right Unitor**  $\text{Ru} : \text{AtlHorSum}(F, \text{Atl}) \rightarrow F$  remove the empty tag family.

## 11 Data Transformations

**Definition 11.1** (The Category of Data Transformations). The **Category of Data Transformations**, also called the category of **Data Transformation Sets** or **DaTra Sets**, is the presheaf category

$$\text{DaTra} = [\text{Atl}^{\text{op}}, \text{Set}].$$

As a presheaf category, it is a topos.

**Definition 11.2** (Data Transposals). The **Category of Data Transposals**, denoted  $\text{DaTrap}$ , is  $[\text{AtlTrap}^{\text{op}}, \text{Set}]$ .

**Definition 11.3** (Ordered Data Transposals). The **Category of Ordered Data Transposals**, denoted  $\text{OrdDaTrap}$ , is  $[\text{OrdAtlTrap}^{\text{op}}, \text{Set}]$ .

**Definition 11.4** (Data Transversals). The **Category of Data Transversals**, denoted  $\text{DaTrav}$ , is  $[\text{AtlTrav}^{\text{op}}, \text{Set}]$ .

**Definition 11.5** (Stable Data Transversals). The **Category of Stable Data Transversals**, denoted  $\text{StaDaTrav}$ , is  $[\text{StaAtlTrav}^{\text{op}}, \text{Set}]$ .

**Definition 11.6** (Navigation). A **navigation** of  $D : \text{DaTra}$  is a monomorphism  $\text{Nav} : \text{Yo}(A) \rightarrow D$  for some atlas  $A$ .

**Definition 11.7** (Expedition). An **expedition** is a navigation represented by an Atlas Map.

**Definition 11.8** (Data Transformation Maps). The **Category of Data Transformation Maps**, denoted  $\text{DaTraMap}$ , is the full subcategory of  $\text{DaTra Sets}$  all of whose navigations are expeditions.

## 12 Stable Data Transformations

**Definition 12.1** (Stable Data Transformations). The **Category of Stable Data Transformations**, denoted  $\text{StaDaTra}$ , is the presheaf category on Atlas Confederations whose component arrows lie in  $\text{StaAtlTrav}$ . Correspondingly, each stable data transformation has an underlying DaTra presheaf.

**Definition 12.2** (The Empty Map). The **Empty Map**, denoted  $I$ , is the Day unit represented by the empty Atlas Confederation:

$$I = \text{Yo}(\text{Atl}).$$

**Definition 12.3** (The Horizontal Sum Bifunctor). The **Horizontal Sum Bifunctor**, denoted  $\text{HorSum} : \text{StaDaTra} \times \text{StaDaTra} \rightarrow \text{StaDaTra}$ , or in infix notation by  $\boxplus : \text{StaDaTra} \times \text{StaDaTra} \rightarrow \text{StaDaTra}$ , is the Day convolution extension of stable atlas horizontal sum. Because the indexing morphisms are arrows of  $\text{StaAtlTrav}$ , its result and its arrow action land in  $\text{StaDaTra}$  by construction.

**Definition 12.4** (Stable Data Transformations Monoidal Category). The **Stable Data Transformations Monoidal Category**, denoted  $\text{StaDaTraMon}$ , is

$$\text{StaDaTraMon} = (\text{StaDaTra}, \boxplus, I).$$

Its tensor is Day convolution on the Atlas Confederation. Its braider, associator, and unitors are based on the Atlas Braider, Atlas Associator, and Atlas Unitors of Definitions 10.6–10.8, respectively.